

Speaker 1 [00:00:01] Q Okay. So. Hi. Thank you again for meeting with me. And as I mentioned over text, we want to know more about your views on romantic relationships. And we believe your experience and perspective would bring much to the project. I already asked you this, but I need to ask you again for the recording. Is it okay if we record the interview?

Speaker 2 [00:00:28] Yes.

Speaker 2 [00:00:30] I'm assuming you're not planning on showing the recording the way I was reading that disclosure that I was signing was I was signing away text, not recordings.

Speaker 1 [00:00:41] Basically. Yeah. The recording will be turned into a transcript, so it's just being used to record it and then we'll make it into a transcription. The video won't be used for the research.

Speaker 2 [00:00:53] Yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:00:55] So yeah, let's get started. Some demographic questions. How old are you?

Speaker 2 [00:01:04] [46-50].

Speaker 1 [00:01:06] How long have you been together with your partner?

Speaker 2 [00:01:13] I joked with him like, we should compare answers. I think, [26-30] years.

Speaker 2 [00:01:23] To make it.

Speaker 1 [00:01:28] Do you have children?

Speaker 2 [00:01:30] Yes.

Speaker 1 [00:01:32] Who is in the household right now.

Speaker 2 [00:01:35] [1-5] of the kids, but [1-5] is here, like temporarily and between apartments. So we have [1-5] living at home and they are [11-15]. And the one that is probably moving back out in about a [duration] is [20-25].

Speaker 1 [00:01:51] Okay, nice. What is your main source of income and what is your current job?

Speaker 2 [00:01:57] Mine. [Occupation].

Speaker 1 [00:02:02] Oh, nice. Nice. It's actually what I want to do when I grow up. yeah, that's why.

Speaker 2 [00:02:07] I like it. It's.

Speaker 1 [00:02:10] I'm glad because I'm quite scared. So I think.

Speaker 2 [00:02:15] Yeah, yeah, yeah. It's. Yeah, it's fun. Most days are very fun.

Speaker 1 [00:02:22] Okay, good, good. How'd you get. Okay. This is, like, not really. But how did you get into that?

Speaker 2 [00:02:28] Um, yeah, so I wanted to. I actually wanted to do [occupation]. That was harder to find in terms of getting a degree. And so I was always kind of debating between [occupation] or [occupation]. My mom's a [occupation]. Yeah. Yeah. So when I decided not to be an [occupation], those were the two fields I was kind of going for. And so I got my undergraduate degree, actually, in [degree] education.

Speaker 1 [00:03:03] nice.

Speaker 2 [00:03:04] And very quickly, in a [occupation] environment, I realized that I didn't really care that much about what I was doing. I was carrying more about the connection with the kids and having it be not so much of a group. Class type connection of like, Hey, let's just hang out at your little pod of dust and see how you guys are doing. Because it was [grade level].

Speaker 2 [00:03:30] [Grade level] sucks.

Speaker 2 [00:03:34] Just in general.

Speaker 1 [00:03:36] I definitely agree with that statement.

Speaker 2 [00:03:39] So. Yeah. Yeah. So. So I. It was a stay at home mom. For like [11-15] years or something around that. And so then I went back and got my master's.

Speaker 1 [00:03:57] Well, your match is in [specialization].

Speaker 2 [00:04:00] My masters is in [specialization].

Speaker 1 [00:04:04] Oh, okay. Okay, okay. That's interesting. Okay. I didn't know that was something they offer. That's. I've.

Speaker 2 [00:04:09] Okay. Yeah. Yeah. So it's. It's kind of like the the pairing twin to [occupation]. [Occupation] is more a case management focused and [occupation] is more like deep dive into the [field]. But they crossover like a lot like I work with some [occupation].

Speaker 1 [00:04:32] Okay. It makes sense. Yeah. Okay. But actually clarify things in my head. So I just very interested because he's, like, looking into. And I'm, like, a little bit stressed about it, but. Yeah. Okay. Thank you for.

Speaker 1 [00:04:45] Clarifying that.

Speaker 2 [00:04:46] No Problem. Yeah. Yeah. And if you're ever local, you're welcome to come on by. And I'm happy to. Enough to let you even. I'm going to be starting up an [event] and stuff so you can come check.

Speaker 1 [00:04:58] That out, too. Oh.

Speaker 1 [00:05:00] Yeah. Thank you so much.

Speaker 2 [00:05:02] Yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:05:03] What do you. Sorry. This is still, like, not. Do you work with anyone in particular or do you kind of work with everyone? If that. Makes sense

Speaker 2 [00:05:10]. The population? Yeah. So up until recently, I was working at a [location] that's called. So it's [event], meaning that substance is usually the primary. And then there's a struggle that that substance was trying to treat. And so I did that for. [6-10], almost [6-10] years on. So. Gosh. And. That was a lot. So I decided to take a break and so did private practice simultaneously, and then decided I wanted to do private practice exclusively. And so now that private practice is opening up an [event]. But in private practice, I work with.

Speaker 2 [00:06:01] Have.

Speaker 2 [00:06:02] I'm kind of debating on keeping this kid or not. I mean, I know that's kind of but I have an [6-10] year old kid and I'm like proof that might be too young, but I do work with [population] and [population]. And so because of my substance. Focus. Quite a few of the [population] I work with have a substance problem as well as mental health. And so with mental health I see primarily trauma and anxiety depression. Some mood disorders, some personality.

Speaker 2 [00:06:37] Disorders.

Speaker 2 [00:06:38] Like, I actually enjoy working with bipolar and borderline personality disorder.

Speaker 2 [00:06:46] So.

Speaker 1 [00:06:49] That's so interesting. Okay. You make me very excited for my future.

Speaker 2 [00:06:53] Okay, cool.

Speaker 1 [00:06:58] So back to the original set of questions. Sorry about that. Sorry for that aside, but I was very intrigued.

Speaker 2 [00:07:05] You're good.

Speaker 1 [00:07:08] How would you like me to address your partner? So, like, husband, boyfriend, partner, etc.. Like any of those?

Speaker 2 [00:07:15] Yeah, I don't care. [Partner's Name].

Speaker 2 [00:07:19] You know I don't have a preference.

Speaker 1 [00:07:24] Okay. Okay, cool. Sounds good. Um, can you tell me what your love story.

Speaker 2 [00:07:33] Our love story. Yeah. So, like I say, I initially wanted to be an [occupation], so we met in college. He it was a [school], and we were on the same floor

[year]. And so we were just kind of good friends and. A mutual good friend of ours was getting married. And so this friend asked for me to be in the wedding party as well as [Partner's Name]. And so by this time I was already back in [Country]. So I flew out for the wedding and and I stopped off on my way to and from [Country]. And so it wasn't like, oh, I haven't seen this person for a couple of years. You know, I saw him every like [6-10] months or something when I was, like, flying between places. So anyways, wedding night not to get to, but I my husband and I decided to hook up. And I was due to fly back to [Country] at the end of that. Weekend. And so. We continued to enjoy the weekend and early early that morning before I was supposed to fly out, he kind of went through this little panicky thing.

Speaker 2 [00:09:08] And.

Speaker 2 [00:09:09] Asked the me to marry him. So, yeah. So technically, we dated for [1-5] days before we were married. But but we've known each other for about for, well, like [1-5] years or [1-5] and a half years at that time. So it wasn't I mean, it's not like I we do enjoy kind of like teasing people. Like, yeah, I decided to get married after [1-5] days of dating.

Speaker 2 [00:09:39] Which is.

Speaker 2 [00:09:40] True, but it wasn't that. I mean, it was pretty impulsive, though.

Speaker 2 [00:09:46] Yeah.

Speaker 2 [00:09:46] Yeah. That was like [Time] or so in the morning. And I woke up the next morning and I was like, I'm still okay with this.

Speaker 1 [00:09:58] I'm glad you didn't have have any regrets. It's good.

Speaker 2 [00:10:02] So, yeah, I was it.

Speaker 1 [00:10:06] That's good. I love a good story. Uh huh. And how would you compare the quality of your relationship compared to that of like your friends relationships?

Speaker 2 [00:10:20] Like other friends or married or not married.

Speaker 1 [00:10:22] Married or unmarried, either one, like any kind of relationship.

Speaker 2 [00:10:29] I'm not sure if I fully in terms of. I ask the question again, I'm not sure.

Speaker 1 [00:10:39] Yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:10:40] How would you compare the quality of your relationship compared to that of your friends relationships? So, like friends, romantic relationships, they can be very romantic.

Speaker 2 [00:10:54] Most I'd say most of. My married friends. We've all been kind of married for quite a while, and so the marriages are like, mature. There's a there is an ease and a comfort with them. The friends I have that have gotten divorced, married did that. I

had quite a few friends get divorced when they had young kids like toddlers. But I get because young kids are terrible in a marriage. And so, yeah, there's an ease and comfort. And I think [Partner's Name] and I, we've always been chatter boxes and so our communication has always been pretty good. I was actually reflecting, though, with a friend. Recently that I think. Our marriage. Honestly, our marriage is better than it probably ever has been. And I think it's because we're doing a better job of actually listening. So it's not like, Oh, we need to talk more because we both talk plenty. But actually listening to each other's back.

Speaker 1 [00:12:14] Yeah.

Speaker 2 [00:12:16] So, yeah, I'd say it's good. It really is. I don't. Yeah. But, I don't really have any friends that I'd say they're in a marriage, that they're not just enjoying each other.

Speaker 1 [00:12:38] That's good.

Speaker 2 [00:12:39] Yeah. The ones that were just kind of, like living in the same house. They're divorced.

Speaker 2 [00:12:46] Mm. Got it. Yeah. Which is good because.

Speaker 2 [00:12:51] If you need to figure it out or you. Like you live your life in a happier way.

Speaker 1 [00:13:00] Exactly. Exactly.

Speaker 2 [00:13:01] Yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:13:05] And how many running partners have you had in the past? Like before, [Partner's Name]?

Speaker 2 [00:13:08] How many what.

Speaker 1 [00:13:09] Romantic partners have you had in the past? Like before? [Partner's Name]?

Speaker 2 [00:13:13] And are we talking about emotionally or, like, sex partners?

Speaker 1 [00:13:19] Um.

Speaker 1 [00:13:20] It's based on your definition.

Speaker 1 [00:13:23] But I would say I go off of, like, romantic partners rather than sexual partners.

Speaker 2 [00:13:29] Okay, I was going to say, I mean, cause I definitely had one night stands. But not not a big emotional attachment. You know, like, oh, it's like you think you're I mean, cause your hormones and everything are going crazy. It's like, Oh, they're awesome. But then a week goes by and you're like, you know, so they don't come. Okay, so. [1-5].

Speaker 2 [00:13:56] [1-5].

Speaker 2 [00:13:59] And we're just doing significant ones.

Speaker 2 [00:14:02] Right? Yeah, sure.

Speaker 2 [00:14:04] That's what I'm.

Speaker 2 [00:14:04] Doing. Right.

Speaker 2 [00:14:06] All right. So I have one, too. [1-5]. For.

Speaker 2 [00:14:20] [1-5] [6-10].

Speaker 1 [00:14:28] Okay, So. Okay.

Speaker 2 [00:14:29] I was a serial dater.

Speaker 2 [00:14:32] Okay.

Speaker 2 [00:14:33] Right. Like, I. So, yeah, I averaged a significant relationship, like. For most of my teen years until I got married. And in between that, I would just have one night stands and whatnot. So. Yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:14:52] Got it.

Speaker 2 [00:14:53] Got it. Yeah. Okay.

Speaker 2 [00:14:56] Some of those lasted. You know what? I think the longest before [Partner's Name] was maybe a little over a year.

Speaker 1 [00:15:07] Okay. Yeah. And how would you compare the quality of, like, your relationship currently to, like, the ones that you had previously?

Speaker 2 [00:15:17] I am definitely more comfortable and authentic. I'm also a lot older. And so my hormones aren't As bonkers. Yeah. No, I think just they're just more authentically comfortable. And I think that that's probably because [Partner's Name] and I were friends for. Like I said, almost [1-5] years before we became. Like romantically involved. And so our relationship was very much built on a friendship and.

Speaker 1 [00:16:01] Yeah.

Speaker 2 [00:16:02] In a friendship where we knew each other doing their. Their stuff. Right. You know, like. You know, I've seen what you've done. You better not be doing that while we're together. You know, kind of things, right? So there is that authenticity and openness that didn't really even need to be communicated between us. It was just kind of a known given.

Speaker 1 [00:16:28] Makes sense. Okay. Yeah, yeah, yeah. That makes more sense. Yeah. Yeah, I understand. Yeah. And for you, I know you probably have talked about this a little bit, but like, what makes a relationship like higher quality or lower quality?

Speaker 2 [00:16:42] Um.

Speaker 2 [00:16:46] Hiding. You know, as a [occupation], I see a lot of hiding and. The. Being in a relationship where you're you're in this place where you're thinking this person, oh, they have so much potential and they're going to change rather than just loving and enjoying the person who they are right now.

Speaker 2 [00:17:15] Mm hmm.

Speaker 2 [00:17:15] And who they are today. And I grew up with two parents that one of them was constantly waiting for the other person to change.

Speaker 2 [00:17:28] And.

Speaker 2 [00:17:29] Not helping.

Speaker 1 [00:17:31] Yeah.

Speaker 2 [00:17:32] Um. So yeah, just deciding if you're happy with who you have as a partner today. I'm not really expecting anything more anything less.

Speaker 2 [00:17:47] And.

Speaker 2 [00:17:50] The ability to forgive as big. Recognizing we all matter. And nice to be able to not hold a singular event as a definition of a relationship.

Speaker 2 [00:18:08] And.

Speaker 2 [00:18:13] LAUGHTER. Playfulness. Right. Remembering that there is a reason you decide to get married. It's not super serious all the time.

Speaker 2 [00:18:24] Now it's a.

Speaker 2 [00:18:28] And communication. I mean, communication really is helpful. With that often authenticity. I feel like communication just naturally follows.

Speaker 1 [00:18:39] So. Yeah. Yeah. Yeah, I.

Speaker 1 [00:18:43] Know it sounds and you mentioned communication, So when would you say you had good communication? Like, what happened then?

Speaker 2 [00:18:59] [Partner's Name] and I figured out how to. fight kindly merely early in our marriage. Up until a couple of years ago, we would have a major blowout about every [6-10] to [11-15] months. But. I'm trying to think and I think we've had a blowout since I had cancer, and that was [6-10] years ago. And so the good communication is, is that being able to openly just talk about this is what's going on. Are you okay with this? Is that going to happen? Right cause That alleviates a lot of the like the stories that we tell ourselves in terms of what actually is going to occur without actually confirming if that's going to occur or the story of this person is thinking this about me because they just acted that way versus just asking them what's going on? Are you pissed at me because you're seeming like you are? You know, so solid communication that way. And then in terms of when you're going to fail, it's the idea of fighting with the goal that nobody wins and you're

fighting to try to move forward. In in solving something, in working together, in being able to move in a forward positive progression in the relationship. And it's okay if it doesn't get solved and settled. Not everything gets solved and settled. Like I. I don't like that you're doing that and you're still doing it. And so I will figure out what I'm going to do. But you keep doing that. And decide if I'm okay with sitting with that or not. Right. So. Yep.

Speaker 1 [00:21:07] And for you, like what is the most important? Like, what are some of the most important things in a relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:21:14] Oh.

Speaker 2 [00:21:22] Kindness. Compassion. A desire to. want to work together as a team. A love for each other. Not just love because you have kids together and everything else. It's like you actually love the person as an individual. I don't know. Just kind of feeling comfortable doing and saying whatever. And knowing that.

Speaker 2 [00:22:00] It's okay. Even if it's not okay. So just a solid trust. In in the person you're with, but solid trust in the relationship that it can go through.

Speaker 2 [00:22:18] Like.

Speaker 2 [00:22:20] Storms, and it's okay.

Speaker 2 [00:22:27] Does that answer?

Speaker 1 [00:22:28] Yeah, yeah.

Speaker 2 [00:22:30] Yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:22:31] And you mentioned love. So, like, the next question actually is, like, for you. Like, what is love?

Speaker 2 [00:22:39] Right. I mean, such it's like broad, and we use it so frequently.

Speaker 2 [00:22:46] There.

Speaker 2 [00:22:48] A love is just a feeling of deep connection for me. I guess it's.

Speaker 2 [00:22:54] And.

Speaker 2 [00:22:59] It's it's the feeling within my body when I think of the person and and it's like all of a sudden I have a warmth and. And a sense of groundedness, a sense of added confidence. And in myself, knowing I am loved and I do love. So. Yeah. And I can go to lots of things, not just myself. But thinking of them and being like, Oh, this is someone I love to be around. This is someone who, when I see them, it's either this like, Okay. Or it's passionate or even if it's like, you know, like, I don't know, like my husband just walked into the room. Like half an hour ago. And without looking up, I knew it was him because I knew his footsteps. So it's just that familiar, like.

Speaker 2 [00:24:11] Yeah. It's fine. Yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:24:17] And how important do you think love is in a relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:24:23] Very.

Speaker 2 [00:24:25] I think, passion. Passion comes and goes. It's like, man. But now I think that love. Love is important. Because you can either even sometimes you don't like the person. Yeah. I mean, that's why I mean, it's like trust in the relationship and trust in all of those things. If. If I'm not feeling. That connected peace. I'm not. I don't know. Feels like it's more of a business transaction. It doesn't sound very fun.

Speaker 1 [00:25:18] Yeah, I would agree with that.

Speaker 2 [00:25:23] So very. But, you know, I mean.

Speaker 2 [00:25:26] I think that's true for.

Speaker 2 [00:25:27] Friendships. Like, I love my friends. And the ones that start to have that kind of ick and we wind up becoming acquaintances, are we just stop talking. So yeah, that'll be fun for you to like, figure out how to do that on the text. With thatThat nice noise I made.

Speaker 1 [00:25:53] Yeah. Oh, right. For that.

Speaker 2 [00:25:55] They'll be trying to write like, I almost want to see the script just to hear that.

Speaker 1 [00:26:03] Yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:26:04] And the next question is. How do you know that [Partner's Name] loves you?

Speaker 2 [00:26:09] Hmm.

Speaker 2 [00:26:11] Well, one, he tells me ad nauseum.

Speaker 2 [00:26:14] Like a.

Speaker 2 [00:26:15] Lot. [Partner's Name] is very affectionate. And he is. He. He's much better at it than I am. Like, I'm pretty much all those things, like we like to tease each other, that I'm the guy in the relationship and he's the romantic, you know? He remembers our wedding anniversary. It wasn't until this year. Because he likes to randomly, like, really annoying. He likes to randomly ask when we got married. I got it right this year. It only took a [26-30] year marriage, but, you know, I got it.

Speaker 2 [00:27:02] Made.

Speaker 2 [00:27:03] And yeah so he he he's liberal with his compliments He's liberal he's he's a really good cheerleader. And so it's like sharing an accomplishment. And he's like, awesome. And he has the things where it's like, you know, towards the evening he'll be like, Oh, I told you, I love you today. yet. Yeah, he he's he's just good about it. He is. And he shows it. He really does. He helps around the house. Since I started working full time, he does more housework than I do. Um. So not only is he saying that he loves me, but he's saying that he loves and supports who I am and what I do.

Speaker 2 [00:28:00] Just nice. Yeah.

Speaker 2 [00:28:02] Yeah, I married a good one.

Speaker 1 [00:28:04] You really.

Speaker 1 [00:28:06] Sound like you.

Speaker 1 [00:28:07] Did.

Speaker 2 [00:28:07] I'm just saying. We've joked if one dies before the other and stuff, [Partner's Name] will get remarried within [1-5] years. Probably [1-5] years. I mean, he just. Well, I will not. And we're both really comfortable and we both are in agreement that that is how it would happen.

Speaker 1 [00:28:32] Okay. I like that you're in agreement. That's very good. That's very.

Speaker 2 [00:28:36] Yeah. No, I would want him to.

Speaker 1 [00:28:39] That's good.

Speaker 2 [00:28:40] Because. He he enjoys very much. Being with someone. I enjoy being with [Partner's Name].

Speaker 1 [00:28:57] Very sweet.

Speaker 1 [00:28:59] Going on like a different route now. What are some challenges in your relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:29:12] At the beginning of our marriage, ah, one of our challenges was thinking we were good at communication and we actually were not. And so at the [6-10] year mark. It was around the [6-10] year mark was probably the most difficult period of our marriage. Honestly, out of our whole marriage, that's the only time. And we actually might not make it through this. And that all stemmed down from a communication. And both of us making assumptions in both. You know, and honestly, [Partner's Name] was pretty. Being selfish during.

Speaker 2 [00:30:01] This.

Speaker 2 [00:30:01] Year just was and he'll admit that he was. And and I think that it was accumulation building up all the way up into that point because he. And I very much support. He is extraordinarily independent and he likes to go and dabble and do all sorts of different things. Like after this, he I mean, he's gone now and he's driven up to. to go do an [class type] class. And I support it and I want him to honestly, if he didn't go and do all these bizarre things all over the place, he would go bonkers and he would be a horrible person to live with. I would not enjoy it. But when we had young kids and he was still doing that, plus he was traveling a lot more for work. I. It was like that piece for I supported it and I wanted him to do it, but I was also feeling used. Like, well, you know, I'll be the built in babysitter while this occurs and stuff and. And when I would try to communicate that the solution. That [Partner's Name] would come up with. It was like, Well, that's the solution. But it wasn't. It wasn't a solution I was happy with, but I wasn't communicating that. And so

we. We just weren't in sync on a lot of those things. And so when we had the blowout. And I was pretty significantly injured. Like, I had just had knee surgery and I was stuck in bed and the kids had chickenpox.

Speaker 2 [00:31:58] Okay, We're going.

Speaker 2 [00:31:59] To paint that picture. I could not get out of bed without crutches and my. We had a [1-5] year old now. Wasn't it a little bit older than that? It was our [6-10th] year, I don't know. Anyway, we had toddlers, right? And [Partner's Name] One was headed out of town for the weekend to do a show.

Speaker 2 [00:32:26] Yeah.

Speaker 2 [00:32:27] I did not communicate that I wasn't okay with him leaving, and I wanted him to be the person to help take care of me. And he did not pick up on the cue that maybe that would have been something nice for him to do. And so instead he prepared for a friend of ours to to come and take care of me and the kids.

Speaker 2 [00:32:53] So.

Speaker 2 [00:32:55] But it was on both of us, right? Like the communication piece that was.

Speaker 2 [00:33:00] That was big.

Speaker 2 [00:33:02] So and we grew from that. We came to realize, like we we both we both definitely.

Speaker 2 [00:33:09] Played a part.

Speaker 2 [00:33:12] In this.

Speaker 2 [00:33:15] And.

Speaker 2 [00:33:16] Any other time I have been significantly injured. He will joke and be like, I am not going to get a job.

Speaker 2 [00:33:22] Until you.

Speaker 2 [00:33:23] Actually say it's okay. I'm very accident prone. This is a thing. Erm Yeah. So that that's been problematic and I think just the kids being young, like I said it's. It. I love the kids, but I was a stay at home mom. And so my whole world, that was my job and I lived my job. And so there was definitely a disconnect that happened between [Partner's Name] and I. Plus we did co-sleeping. Which just meant that sex got creative.

Speaker 2 [00:34:05] You know, because your bed is not.

Speaker 2 [00:34:09] It wasn't a place that we were comfortable having sex with the kids sleeping next to us. And so there were you know, there were definite changes and stuff that were going on in that. It's getting older is definitely also I think helped the marriage.

Speaker 2 [00:34:33] Yeah, I'd say that's pretty much it.

Speaker 2 [00:34:38] Answer Cancer.

Speaker 2 [00:34:38] Sucked.

Speaker 1 [00:34:41] That wasn't fun.

Speaker 2 [00:34:42] And it wasn't.

Speaker 2 [00:34:46] But. And [Partner's Name] and I have talked about this. And cancer also brought us closer together. So. Certainly don't wish. It to happen ever again. But but it definitely gave gifts. While it was also taking some in so.

Speaker 2 [00:35:17] You know.

Speaker 1 [00:35:18] Before that was a very detailed response. I think the you and [Partner's Name] fight.

Speaker 2 [00:35:27] Yeah. Yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:35:29] And how long would you say your fights last?

Speaker 2 [00:35:33] But I don't. And, you know, and that's why. I mean. I mean, like an actual, like, fight. Fight. It's been quite a while. Like. But yeah, we do have we do have disagreement for sure. I mean, we're both pretty opinionated people and we. Both can be stubborn, and [Partner's Name] likes to tease me that I don't like to be wrong. I'm getting a lot better. It is man therapy tools and I still sometimes. But yeah, in terms of like an argument that is like heated, like, I don't want to.

Speaker 2 [00:36:29] Talk to you for a bit.

Speaker 2 [00:36:36] I'd say maybe. Maybe it lasts, like, an hour. Maybe a couple of hours. A lot of times it depends on what's going on, because we're pretty upfront in terms of if something is going on and we're not happy, we'll tell the other person like straight away. But if it's like around the kids and stuff, we still tell each other like straight away. But then there's kind of this unspoken, like, we're going to just kind of put a peg in that one until we have time to actually talk to each other more in depth. But a lot of times if we get into a disagreement and we're kind of like the kids start chanting two Christmases. And that usually makes us laugh when we start.

Speaker 2 [00:37:34] It's like, whatever.

Speaker 1 [00:37:39] A minute of.

Speaker 2 [00:37:45] It was an improv thing that the [Partner's Name] was doing with the two older kids. Like back when they were in high school and they were doing a performance show or something and something happened and it was like, yeah, it was like bemoaning the divorce and everything else. And I can't remember which of the kids. They're like, No, I love my dad. It's fine. I'm good. It's okay. I got two Christmases. I get twice of everything.

Speaker 1 [00:38:16] Exactly right.

Speaker 2 [00:38:19] Like what? No. Why would I be upset?

Speaker 2 [00:38:25] So yeah.

Speaker 2 [00:38:26] It comes from that

Speaker 2 [00:38:26] That it's.

Speaker 1 [00:38:29] And in asking, how often you say like you fight or argue.

Speaker 2 [00:38:36] Mm.

Speaker 2 [00:38:44] And disagree. Pretty regular. Which I'm glad. Now that we have those kind of talks and stuff. It. I think is the main reason we haven't had a major blowout fight in quite a while.

Speaker 2 [00:39:11] Hmm.

Speaker 2 [00:39:14] You know, every couple of months.

Speaker 2 [00:39:17] Oh, yeah.

Speaker 2 [00:39:18] It's not that often.

Speaker 1 [00:39:22] Yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:39:24] How do you usually.

Speaker 2 [00:39:25] I don't know. Yeah.

Speaker 2 [00:39:27] I don't know. I do have chemo brain. And so sometimes those kind of things, I truly don't know.

Speaker 1 [00:39:32] Oh, okay.

Speaker 2 [00:39:37] Maybe that's also helpful for our marriage. So that happened. Really? Okay.

Speaker 1 [00:39:48] I think it would be nice. And like when these fights arguments come about, like, I know you talk about like the two Christmases, but I know there's other ways that you like resolve your fights and arguments as well.

Speaker 2 [00:40:04] Yeah, that, that honestly, that just goes down to like good communication skills. And that's why it said that we learned how to stop fighting dirty. And so fighting dirty is scorekeeping. Fighting dirty.

Speaker 2 [00:40:20] Is.

Speaker 2 [00:40:22] trying to be the winner, not actually trying to understand and really actually listen to the other person. So yeah. So when we have a disagreement about something, it's it's pretty focused and direct that this is what we're talking about. We're not

bringing in what they did [1-5] years ago and what this happened and that happened. We're not going into the whole storytelling aspect of it because. They're both true. And so do they actually really matter. So we both very quickly go into speaking about how we're feeling. And our perceptions. And so being pretty careful in our language with each other. Erm. And if so, then if it starts to get where one of us gets more heated or like I'm starting to get to the point where I'm not being conscious with what I'm saying. We wind up taking a break. And then kind of coming back to it. Yeah. Yeah. I don't know. And [Partner's Name]'s really good at following up and coming back to things like I'm remembering. I don't know. Couple of weeks ago. I was having this weird interaction with a former client. Who? Lashed out. And lost it. And so It had been kind of a hard day. I was emotionally shot and I mentioned some of that like hurt to [Partner's Name]. And and I said something and he responded and it sounded like she was making fun of what I had just gone through. And so I was. I was pretty emotionally activated and pretty.

Speaker 2 [00:42:44] Pissed.

Speaker 2 [00:42:45] And. But I didn't want to say anything further other than like. I did not appreciate that kind of a thing and left. Because I needed to regulate because I was going to go have a session, a sessions like I got [duration] to get my emotions back in check here. Thanks, dude. So anyways, he came up and he was like, Something is off and I'm not sure. What happened? I had totally heard him incorrectly. He had said something completely different. It sounded very similar, like the words kind of a thing. And so. So just good at following up and stuff like that. But he also gave me [1-5] minutes to cool down.

Speaker 2 [00:43:42] He.

Speaker 2 [00:43:44] Because I knew that I probably wasn't going to hear him. So it's coming to understand that in both of us.

Speaker 2 [00:43:54] So.

Speaker 2 [00:43:57] That's it for us. That's what fighting fair means.

Speaker 1 [00:44:03] Yeah, it sounds great. It sounds like you guys, at least somewhat have it figured it out.

Speaker 2 [00:44:08] Yeah. Yeah. Well, I mean, and in that instance, he also. You know, I said, thank you. For my telling him I was angry at him. Right. And I thanked him for. Not just letting it lie. When he realized that there was probably a misunderstanding going on.

Speaker 2 [00:44:36] So. Yeah.

Speaker 2 [00:44:40] We're also complementary of each other.

Speaker 2 [00:44:43] So that's good. That's good.

Speaker 1 [00:44:47] You talk a lot about like communication. And aside from communication, what are other ways that you maintain your relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:45:01] My husband is very like before we got married. Married? We wound up doing that whole, like, love language thing and all that stuff and. We had to go through all this extra crap because my husband was insistent that we have a [religion] marriage. I

do not recommend the rhythm method that was part of the [religion] training stuff we had to do. But anyway, one of the helpful things in it was going in finding out what the love languages are of each of us, and we discovered that our love languages are not the same. And so and [Partner's Name]'s is like contact. Physical touch. And so. Even though I really a lot of times could care less about physical touch it. Sometimes it honestly can be irritating. It's over the years been really helpful for me to know that that's what he hears. Love. From me. And so consciously doing things that are physical touch and sex. But but it's like if we're watching TV not hanging out over here on this side of the soap, even though.

Speaker 2 [00:46:27] It would be really.

Speaker 2 [00:46:28] Comfortable and coming over and actually snuggling and before going to work. Like even with young kids and stuff, there was a routine of we give each other a hug and a kiss goodbye and tell each other we love them. And when he comes home from work. And now when I come home from work, I see works at home. It's first time we see each other. We give each other a kiss and ask each other how the day was and. So there's. There are rituals and routines that are in place that are comforting, but they also can help to remind that whole trust of the marriage when things are not going well and we still work hard to still do those things. So it's that reminder of like right now I don't necessarily like you, but I do love you. And so I'm going to keep doing these things because I love you and. And [Partner's Name], lets me talk.

Speaker 2 [00:47:41] And he talks back.

Speaker 2 [00:47:43] Because my big love language is communication and acts service. So yeah. So my husband doing the dishes. Thank you.

Speaker 2 [00:47:59] It's pretty awesome. So. Yeah, yeah.

Speaker 2 [00:48:06] Yeah. And sending each other texts throughout the day. You know, just like random. I was thinking of you kind of tax and so it doesn't feel business transactional. There's a mild flirtation that winds up going on kinda consistently. Which one you write, you should be able to flirt with your partner.

Speaker 1 [00:48:38] I agree.

Speaker 1 [00:48:38] I agree. I think it's a good way to go about it.

Speaker 1 [00:48:46] Yeah. And would you say the relationship, your relationship is good for you and why?

Speaker 2 [00:48:51] Yeah, it definitely is it. He's he. In therapy. You talk to people about anchors. You know, people, places, things that just bring a sense of security and steadiness. And. And [Partner's Name] is one of my anchors. Our marriage is one of my anchors.

Speaker 2 [00:49:35] Uh, and I'm.

Speaker 2 [00:49:40] I like to describe my life is living in controlled chaos. Like, I actually really thrive and enjoy the things being unpredictable. I get bored with some thing and. I

start to not. Perform well and do well. And so I jump around from thing to thing to thing to thing all the time. And it was the main reason I decided to never homeschool my children. It was like my children will get the crappiest education possible because I will dive into being a home school teacher like nobody else's business. And in [1-5] and [6-10] months I'll get bored and go do something else. My poor kids will be like.

Speaker 2 [00:50:29] Well.

Speaker 2 [00:50:32] Okay, we got to this point. And now I don't know how to do math because you left, lady. So.

Speaker 2 [00:50:43] It.

Speaker 2 [00:50:45] So he gives me that security and that safety that it's okay for me to be this like little random, like whatever, because I know I can come back. I know that this is an anchor for me. And so I can change careers. I can. Tell a friend exactly what I think of them, even if I know it's going to. Potentially destroy a friendship. But it's in my best interest. Right. Like, it gives me permission to do hard things.

Speaker 2 [00:51:32] Yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:51:34] Yeah. And do you think the relationship changed you And if so, in what way?

Speaker 2 [00:51:42] Yeah.

Speaker 2 [00:51:43] Very much.

Speaker 2 [00:51:43] So. Yeah.

Speaker 2 [00:51:46] Yeah. So. Getting married and having a family and children. And all of that has made me.

Speaker 2 [00:51:57] Stuck.

Speaker 2 [00:51:58] In [Country]. I. I grew up overseas. I traveled a lot. And I love traveling. And I barely travel anymore. So, yeah, I have definitely become a homebody. You know that whole flick? I got bored and going someplace else.

Speaker 2 [00:52:25] I literally went someplace else and.

Speaker 2 [00:52:33] And that was a conscious choice. I didn't. I didn't I mean, it wasn't like, oh, I got forced into this. It was it was a conscious choice. I didn't I didn't want my children growing up moving all the time and. I wanted my children to have. I sense a stability and stuff and I. And I knew. So I knew what I was getting into. It wasn't a. You know. But that definitely changed me. And so in some ways, it I feel like my. Some of my spirit got stifled, compromised. And it's not just this one. It was me. I chose to do it. I do it.

Speaker 2 [00:53:29] Again. It's okay.

Speaker 2 [00:53:33] I traveled more than. Some people will ever have the opportunity to. I don't need more if it ever. Never happens.

Speaker 2 [00:53:44] Again.

Speaker 1 [00:53:48] That's a good attitude. I like.

Speaker 1 [00:53:50] That. If.

Speaker 1 [00:53:54] What about [Partner's Name]? Did he change in the relationship, do you think?

Speaker 2 [00:53:58] Very much so, yeah. Yeah. You know, like when I was talking about our difficulty with communication early in our relationship and stuff, he has become. Much better at communication, much better at being a peacekeeper, like I've always kind of been a peacekeeper. like oh, Let's calm this down. Let's. You know. But he has changed for the better that way. His tempers. Heavily diminished. He if you grew up in [State], which is a very different culture than [State].

Speaker 2 [00:54:57] Yeah.

Speaker 2 [00:55:00] Where people are much more blunt and direct. And so [Partner's Name] has changed on that, too. He still is direct and he still will tell you what he's thinking and why he's thinking it. But he does it with a lot more tact. He really didn't have a filter.

Speaker 2 [00:55:26] He just didn't.

Speaker 2 [00:55:33] I loved him for it and I loved him. But there were definitely times that I'd be like.

Speaker 2 [00:55:37] oh gosh.

Speaker 2 [00:55:39] You really just said that.

Speaker 2 [00:55:41] Okay. Ooh. Yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:55:48] I've been to [State] before, and it's is definitely a different culture for sure.

Speaker 2 [00:55:53] Yeah. Wow. This is interesting.

Speaker 2 [00:55:56] Yeah, it's funky. And. And there's. Well, in. There's some really unhealthy behaviors there. They're like they're so into they're joking around is. Bringing the other person down and shaming the crap out of them. And it's like, What are you doing? And so that was also [Partner's Name].

Speaker 2 [00:56:24] Yeah.

Speaker 2 [00:56:25] I got to tell him, you can't do that. If we're going to stay married, that doesn't work for me. I don't like that kind of teasing. It's mean. So. Yeah. You do a good job listening and choosing to change.

Speaker 1 [00:56:45] That's good. Yeah.

Speaker 2 [00:56:47] Yeah, right.

Speaker 2 [00:56:48] But it's a good example of choosing to be like, okay, I know this is what I'm marrying and I'm marrying that person. And then when there's a behavior that's coming up and it's coming up repeatedly, being able to.

Speaker 2 [00:57:00] Give a very clear.

Speaker 2 [00:57:02] Communication. I'm not happy with this, but it's still gets to be that other person's decision. I'm not going to expect that they are going to do it. I just got to choose. If he didn't, if I wanted to stay married to.

Speaker 2 [00:57:18] That, I probably wouldn't have.

Speaker 2 [00:57:21] Because that's pretty toxic. And it was starting to affect me and my confidence.

Speaker 2 [00:57:31] So. Yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:57:36] And I know you had touched on this like previously, but do you feel safe in the relationship and like, why would you say so?

Speaker 2 [00:57:43] Yeah. Yeah, because like, instances like that, I can remember when I communicate it to her and I'm like, Oh, you know, and I'm like, In your family, I'm sorry, but your family is mean, you know, to each other and mean, you know, and, and then even the nicknames that his parents had for each other, I.

Speaker 2 [00:58:03] Think.

Speaker 2 [00:58:04] That's not nice. That is not an endearing term. That. He's good at. Not necessarily like, Oh, everything I say is true, but he's good at listening and being able to hear it. So when I point that stuff out to him, his response was actually that was one of the things that attracted him to me was the fact that I didn't do that kind of stuff. And so he wanted to not do that and move away from that. And so that builds trust. And he's pointed out plenty of my flaws, too. Right. And and so it's that piece of like, okay, this is building trust that this person can hear a criticism and not take it as this attack on them as a person is just their behavior sucked.

Speaker 1 [00:59:09] Yeah, yeah.

Speaker 2 [00:59:11] Yeah, yeah.

Speaker 2 [00:59:12] Yeah. still awesome. He's always awesome, But that was a bad behavior.

Speaker 2 [00:59:18] Yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:59:20] the next part of the interview is going to be like on a like a scale. So do you mind if I share my screen real quick?

Speaker 2 [00:59:32] Okay.

Speaker 1 [00:59:35] Okay. So it's like, okay. Can you see this, by the way?

Speaker 2 [00:59:42] Yep. Awesome.

Speaker 1 [00:59:46] So I'm going to ask you a question and you're going to tell me, like, what number you think you are on this scale.

Speaker 2 [00:59:51] Mm hmm.

Speaker 1 [00:59:52] So my partner usually really listens to me. What number.

Speaker 2 [00:59:56] Am. Hmm. Let's say.

Speaker 2 [01:00:01] 7.5 to.

Speaker 1 [01:00:03] Okay. Why not 6.5 or 8.5?

Speaker 2 [01:00:10] Because 8.5 feels like bullshit.

Speaker 2 [01:00:13] Through.

Speaker 2 [01:00:14] It. It would be like, Oh yeah, everything is sunshine and rainbows. And it's like, No, sometimes he is on his phone in the middle of my talking. And he's saying that he's hearing me is not I'm sorry. When I'm on my phone, I can't hear the other person. I think I can. But then I come to and I'm like, No, actually, I didn't really hear [Name] of what you said. But he's also really good at realizing when he is doing something like being on his phone or something like that and putting it down or I'm going to need you to give me a minute. You do not have my attention right now and.

Speaker 2 [01:01:03] So that's why, you know.

Speaker 1 [01:01:10] Oh, there you go. Okay. Sorry I'm bad at this. Okay. The next question is, my partner usually is responsive to my needs. So what number would you think you are?

Speaker 2 [01:01:20] Hmm?

Speaker 2 [01:01:23] He's actually really good at that shit.

Speaker 2 [01:01:27] And.

Speaker 2 [01:01:32] Honestly in these days. I put him up near an eight and a half or nine. I mean, honestly, he. He really is good at it.

Speaker 1 [01:01:44] And why would you not see something like lower?

Speaker 2 [01:01:48] Um, because in our marriage, he has been lowered, and he's not that anymore.

Speaker 1 [01:01:57] I think that's a sound reason.

Speaker 2 [01:01:59] I know they.

Speaker 1 [01:02:06] Right. So the next question is like, how would you rate your satisfaction with the relationship. Yeah. What's your relationship?

Speaker 2 [01:02:16] I put it like an 8.5, 9.

Speaker 1 [01:02:21] Okay. Why not? Like, nine.

Speaker 1 [01:02:27] This time.

Speaker 2 [01:02:28] Not higher when not lower?

Speaker 1 [01:02:29] Yeah, exactly.

Speaker 2 [01:02:31] I feel like I could do better.

Speaker 1 [01:02:36] Okay.

Speaker 1 [01:02:38] And why do you say that?

Speaker 2 [01:02:42] Um.

Speaker 2 [01:02:44] Because sometimes I'm on my phone and not listening.

Speaker 1 [01:02:53] Makes sense.

Speaker 2 [01:02:55] Sometimes I'm more checked out than I want to be.

Speaker 2 [01:02:57] Mm.

Speaker 1 [01:02:58] Yeah. Yeah, that makes sense. Okay. Oh, sorry. I think i somehow missed this, but it's kind of the same question. But like, based on, like, not number scale, but like.

Speaker 1 [01:03:15] A word scale.

Speaker 2 [01:03:16] And honestly, I'd say very satisfied.

Speaker 2 [01:03:20] I'm sorry. Yeah.

Speaker 1 [01:03:23] Nice. Nice. Okay.

Speaker 2 [01:03:24] Awesome.

Speaker 2 [01:03:25] I still don't believe in perfection.

Speaker 2 [01:03:28] Mm hmm.

Speaker 2 [01:03:31] I feel like that's bullshit.

Speaker 2 [01:03:34] So.

Speaker 1 [01:03:37] I agree with you on that. I feel the same way. Nothing can ever be perfect. I mean, not in like, a bad way, but like.

Speaker 2 [01:03:45] No, it shouldn't be.

Speaker 1 [01:03:46] Exactly. That's what I think.

Speaker 2 [01:03:47] Yeah. Yeah. Like, to it being imperfect means you're not a robot. Robots are really boring.

Speaker 1 [01:03:58] Exactly. Perfect. Things are.

Speaker 1 [01:04:00] Boring. Yes, Super boring. Exactly. Look at artwork.

Speaker 1 [01:04:10] Yeah.

Speaker 2 [01:04:11] It's intentionally imperfect a lot of times. So it's more.

Speaker 2 [01:04:18] Interesting. And, you know. And.

Speaker 2 [01:04:26] So did you go to [Place] or how do you know [Name]?

Speaker 2 [01:04:30] Um.

Speaker 1 [01:04:31] I interviewed [Name's] friend.

Speaker 1 [01:04:35] [Name].

Speaker 2 [01:04:37] Oh, okay.

Speaker 1 [01:04:38] Yeah. I don't know. [Name] personally interviewed her, but I don't know her personally. I know her girlfriend personally. We went to the same high school. I'm from the same hometown.

Speaker 2 [01:04:48] Gotcha. Okay.

Speaker 1 [01:04:50] So the pretty, like, long winded, like.

Speaker 2 [01:04:52] Yeah.

Speaker 1 [01:04:53] Association. Yeah, but it's there somewhere.

Speaker 2 [01:04:59] That's awesome.

Speaker 2 [01:05:01] Yeah.

Speaker 2 [01:05:03] I was going to say. So. Now you get to interview almost our whole family, and except for the [20-25] year old, because they're not in a relationship right now.

Speaker 2 [01:05:11] That's too bad.

Speaker 2 [01:05:13] I know right.

Speaker 2 [01:05:14] Yeah.

Speaker 2 [01:05:16] Yeah. Because they they're actually we were actually just talking about it the other day. So. They're into open relationships. Like they've been in a polly closed relationship and they're like, I didn't like that.

Speaker 2 [01:05:40] Yeah. Yeah.

Speaker 2 [01:05:43] No, when they were taking him out there, like, I'm not sure if I'm ever going to want to be in a close relationship ever to. I can appreciate that with the personality of wanting to bounce around to everything. After [6-10] months, it's like, you know, I kind of get.

Speaker 2 [01:06:01] that.

Speaker 2 [01:06:02] To my I say, I'm not going to get remarried. [Partner's Name] is unique.

Speaker 1 [01:06:10] That's very valid.

Speaker 1 [01:06:10] Good.

Speaker 1 [01:06:15] This is the last portion of well, certainly the actual questions. But this is kind of like more personal questions. So if you are to if it's too sensitive for you, you don't want to share like let's talk. Okay, Just let me know. It's about like physical intimacy as a couple. Okay. So the first question is, like, these days, how often do you have sex?

Speaker 2 [01:06:42] Um, well, I was teasing my husband. I think we had sex twice this week. Maybe it was twice last week. No, it's this week. Yeah, we had sex. But yeah, so usually I guess it's probably like 1 to 2 times a week.

Speaker 1 [01:07:05] All right. Okay. And how satisfied are you with your sex life and why would you say so?

Speaker 2 [01:07:10] I am satisfied.

Speaker 2 [01:07:15] Our communication has increased surrounding that and that has. Had our. I don't know. Like our some of the walls that we have built up over the years. Sorry. My shoulders, like, jacked up? No. I had.

Speaker 2 [01:07:42] A.

Speaker 2 [01:07:43] Had start to like. Conflict into our sex life in that we weren't saying things because we were afraid of the other person getting offended or upset or something like that. And so. Yeah. With like, kind of realizing, like, you know, we'd both just rather know where the other person is thinking or what is feeling good or not good or what we're comfortable with and not comfortable with. And and actually not having our feelings get hurt. Which actually really was occurring. Right. And so we both had to do, you know. Our own little work on ourselves in terms of not really taking that personal like, look, this is just

a body. And we're just trying to communicate what our body is enjoying and not enjoyinh. So that's definitely helped a lot.

Speaker 1 [01:08:54] Yeah. Yeah, that sounds great. That's cool. Okay. Um, so those are the last actual questions.

Speaker 1 [01:09:03] Um.

Speaker 1 [01:09:05] We're close to wrapping up, so I would just like to summarize what we've covered just about you. You know what I like? What I have perceived as what you're saying. So it sounds like you're pretty satisfied with your relationship. You have a pretty strong marriage. And one big key factor in this marriage is like communication and talking to each other, also loving each other and being playful at times, not taking things too seriously.

Speaker 1 [01:09:34] You know.

Speaker 1 [01:09:35] You have conflicts, but there aren't like super. Frequent they don't happen frequently and they don't last very long.

Speaker 1 [01:09:45] Yeah.

Speaker 1 [01:09:47] And yeah, overall seems like you're both you're pretty satisfied in your relationship. Is there anything that I missed or something that you would like to add to? But you just talk about everything that you just talked about for now.

Speaker 2 [01:10:02] No, that sounds good.

Speaker 1 [01:10:03] Okay. Awesome.

Speaker 1 [01:10:08] Before we end, I want to talk to you about how we will handle the data. As a research project, we want to be as ethically transparent as possible. And so I want to know which data share option you'd be most comfortable with. So the first option is a transcript. Portions can be shared and none of which can be identified to you. So the de-identified transcript can be read by other researchers. So basically, anything that can be traced back to you will be removed from the transcript, including your name and location, everything like that. The second one is, if you're a little bit bolder, is the whole transcript can be shared and it will be removed like sensitive and overly identifying details. And it will be an anonymized. Although in this option, there is a very minimal chance that someone who knows you well can piece together the details and the transcript and narrow down who among their peers or colleagues they believe it is. Although again, no sensitive information will be shared.

Speaker 2 [01:11:10] So no sensitive information, meaning names are removed and. Location type stuff.

Speaker 1 [01:11:19] Yeah, that's still apparent in that option, yes.

Speaker 2 [01:11:22] Mm hmm.

Speaker 1 [01:11:23] Yeah. So are those two options. Which one are you more comfortable with? You also just go with what you want with your for your consent form, if that's if that's something you want to do. But either way.

Speaker 2 [01:11:37] Yeah. So that second one, where is that transcript released to?

Speaker 1 [01:11:45] It will be released to other researchers in this project. So other the researchers research assistants from [University Name], which is like the part that I work at. But there's also. It's like a multi-country investigation. So there will be people like researchers from other countries potentially looking at it as well. So that's like too much. That's totally fine, too. You can pick option one, but.

Speaker 2 [01:12:14] No, no, it's fine. I was just curious. And so it's so this information. It sounds like this information is going into enough of a multiple hands are going to see it that basically I should be comfortable that this is like a published document.

Speaker 1 [01:12:42] Yeah, potentially.

Speaker 2 [01:12:44] Yeah. Right. I mean.

Speaker 1 [01:12:46] There;s a potential that someone you know, we'll see. But I guess that.

Speaker 2 [01:12:49] , I mean, like. Yeah. You know, like. I work with HIPAA and stuff. And one of the rules also is the amount of people that see the document increase the likelihood that that document is going to be compromised.

Speaker 1 [01:13:07] Right. Right. And so that's why I mean.

Speaker 2 [01:13:14] I think I'm okay. I don't know. You heard me blather on. Is there anything I'd be embarrassed about.

Speaker 1 [01:13:20] And I.

Speaker 1 [01:13:22] Personally wouldn't like.

Speaker 1 [01:13:25] But.

Speaker 2 [01:13:27] I'm trying to I'm honestly trying to go through and go, okay, is there anything in there that. If for some reason in the future one of my kids runs across it and they'd be upset reading it and I don't thinks there is. I think they're pretty aware of. Everything in there. And if not, they'd be like, Oh, interesting. So, yeah, that should be fine.

Speaker 1 [01:13:54] It sounds good. Okay. Awesome.

Speaker 2 [01:13:57] Um.

Speaker 2 [01:13:59] You know, what did [Partner's Name] choose?

Speaker 1 [01:14:02] He said to go with whatever you wrote on the consent form.

Speaker 2 [01:14:06] Okay.

Speaker 1 [01:14:08] Which to be honest, I don't remember.

Speaker 1 [01:14:10] What the.

Speaker 2 [01:14:11] I can't remember either. I think we I think we said whatever. Remembering.

Speaker 2 [01:14:18] Yeah.

Speaker 1 [01:14:23] Yeah. Okay. Yeah. You both. It seems like you both said full transcript. So, like.

Speaker 2 [01:14:29] Yeah, it's fine. Okay.

Speaker 1 [01:14:36] So. Thank you again so much for participating in this study. Part of what how we're getting participants to participate in the study is through snowball sampling. And I don't know, like how much you know about that, but basically, like we ask the participants if they know someone who might be interested in being researched or interviewed, then we ask them .

Speaker 2 [01:15:02] Right.

Speaker 1 [01:15:03] Right. So basically, this last part, this last question for you is basically, if you know anyone who might be interested in being interviewed. My portion of the research specifically is for heterosexual couples. With 20 plus years of relationship, so length of relationship, and then LGBTQ plus couples of any length and non-monogamous couple, not couples, not monogamous relationships. So if you know any one of those.

Speaker 2 [01:15:37] I was guessing my middle child would've been so perfect for you. I didn't know they were dating someone kind of consistently right now. They're on date, I think like [1-5]. But, you know, they're about your age. So that's kind of a big deal.

Speaker 1 [01:15:58] That is true, actually.

Speaker 2 [01:16:02] I'm not I'm not.

Speaker 2 [01:16:03] Being like, Hey. I mean, I'm serious. You know, you usually know by then if it's like, All right, yeah, I can see this going someplace. Yeah, I can think of a couple of people. My parents actually might be good. Oh, yeah. Yeah. My parents got. So my mother and my stepfather.

Speaker 1 [01:16:31] Okay. Yeah. What I can do. This is what I told [Partner's Name]. I can do something different for you if you want it. But I told him I could send you an email of, like, kind of like the demographics that I'm looking for. And if you want, I can also send you, like, what to send to people that you know, so that they know what they're getting themselves into in terms of being interviewed. And then you can send me contacts. I can. I can either either you can send me contacts and I can reach out to them or you can reach out to them, whichever you feel more comfortable with.

Speaker 2 [01:17:02] Yeah.

Speaker 2 [01:17:02] I don't I don't mind. I'm sure my mom my mom is.

Speaker 2 [01:17:07] More open.

Speaker 2 [01:17:08] Book than I am. I'm just not sure if my stepfather would be so.

Speaker 2 [01:17:17] Yeah.

Speaker 2 [01:17:19] But yeah, they have a cool marriage. Honestly, I feel like a lot of. My doing? Well, my marriage is watching my mom choose a second marriage that's very healthy.

Speaker 2 [01:17:33] It's good.

Speaker 2 [01:17:34] And watching a first marriage not healthy. Yeah. No. And I have some friends. That would probably be good.

Speaker 2 [01:17:46] Candidates, too.

Speaker 1 [01:17:48] Okay. Okay. Sounds great. Okay. I will, should I send you an email or Would you rather have a text? I don't know.

Speaker 2 [01:17:54] Why don't you shoot me a text? Okay. The reason that [Partner's Name] emailed.

Speaker 2 [01:17:58] Both of our forms back. Yeah.

Speaker 2 [01:18:06] Let's see. Trying to say, Yeah, I'm doing good. I'm at 10,000 emails.

Speaker 2 [01:18:16] Well, yeah.

Speaker 2 [01:18:18] At one point it was like 50 something.

Speaker 2 [01:18:25] Yeah.

Speaker 1 [01:18:28] I think I'm a oh at 2000.

Speaker 2 [01:18:32] See.

Speaker 1 [01:18:35] That's. Yeah, okay. That's actually worse than I thought it was. To be honest, I've only had this email for like [1-5] years. So that's also a factor.

Speaker 2 [01:18:45] And if you think that. Yeah.

Speaker 2 [01:18:47] Yeah. See you. Just wait. You have a couple more years, you are going to be in the [50-55], like me?

Speaker 1 [01:18:52] Yeah.

Speaker 1 [01:18:53] Oh, yeah, for sure. At this rate, it's definitely. It's definitely coming soon.

Speaker 2 [01:18:56] Yeah, yeah, yeah. No, well, I just never clean out the junk. I never clean out that, you know.

Speaker 1 [01:19:02] I don't either.

Speaker 2 [01:19:06] Yeah, I mean, just stuff gets buried. So don't email me.

Speaker 1 [01:19:08] So. Yeah.

Speaker 2 [01:19:14] Let's see. I'm only. I'm only at 69 on text.

Speaker 1 [01:19:20] Perfect. I'm 12 on text right now. I don't even know what the 12 are. Every time I open it, I swear open all of them. But it keeps saying 12. And I'm.

Speaker 1 [01:19:28] Like.

Speaker 2 [01:19:29] That is really good. No, it's my 21 year old. Whenever they get a hold of my phone, they wind up going through it and they're like, What is this?

Speaker 2 [01:19:41] It's. Oh, yeah.

Speaker 2 [01:19:45] I appreciate their wanting to control my phone in my life. Sometimes it's like clean it out.

Speaker 2 [01:19:50] A.

Speaker 2 [01:19:52] Little dirty word.

Speaker 2 [01:19:53] For.

Speaker 2 [01:19:55] I haven't looked at it, even though I obviously don't care about it. So get rid of it. So yeah, I will ask them. Just texting.

Speaker 2 [01:20:03] Not a problem.

Speaker 1 [01:20:04] Okay. Sounds great. Okay.

Speaker 2 [01:20:06] Okay.

Speaker 1 [01:20:07] Thank you so much again for doing this. This Was very interesting. I really enjoyed speaking with you.

Speaker 2 [01:20:11] Of course. Yeah. And. And I'm serious. [Interviewer's Name]. Is it [Interviewer's Name]? [Interviewer's Name]? Am I saying it right? I don't think I did.

Speaker 1 [01:20:21] It's [Interviewer's Name], like. Like, you know.

Speaker 2 [01:20:22] [Interviewer's Name]. Thank you. Yeah. No, I did not say that. Even close to. Okay. Thank you for correcting me. Yeah. No, I looked at the spelling and I'm like, not even close, But I was serious in terms of if you do have questions, in terms of counseling and all that stuff.

Speaker 2 [01:20:39] Happy to help.

Speaker 2 [01:20:41] I would provide.

Speaker 2 [01:20:41] Answers.

Speaker 1 [01:20:48] thank you. Yeah. So. All right. Well, thank you so much. I'll definitely be in contact with you because I definitely have a lot of questions, so.

Speaker 2 [01:20:53] It really is. Okay.

Speaker 2 [01:20:55] Okay. Awesome. Awesome. Yeah.

Speaker 1 [01:20:57] Okay. Well, thank you so much. This is great.

Speaker 1 [01:21:00] And I look.

Speaker 1 [01:21:01] Forward to speaking with you.

Speaker 2 [01:21:02] All right. Sounds good.

Speaker 2 [01:21:04] Yeah.

Speaker 2 [01:21:05] All right, You take care.

Speaker 1 [01:21:06] You, too.

Speaker 1 [01:21:07] Thank you. All right.

Speaker 2 [01:21:08] Bye bye.